



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

LEGAL-FEE RECEIVABLES RECOVERY · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Debt Collection for Law Firms

Recovering unpaid client fee balances & defaulted payment plans — on pure contingency

Prepared for **Musca Law** · July 2026

A recovery partner for the fees clients leave behind

To the Musca Law team — thank you for reaching out. A statewide criminal-defense practice that offers flat fees, retainers and in-house payment plans carries a specific kind of receivable: earned legal fees a client stops paying once the case resolves, and payment-plan balances that quietly default after representation is complete.

Unpaid fee balances aren't a front-desk problem — they're a cash-flow problem.

Once a matter is closed and the urgency is gone, self-financed retainer shortfalls and defaulted payment plans age into write-offs while your attorneys and staff are focused on the next case, not chasing statements.

Southwest Recovery Services works professional-services and legal receivables on **pure contingency since 2004** — an extension of your firm's billing function for the balances that have stalled. Recovery is **reputation-first**: firm, professional, and protective of the name and reviews you've built across 25+ Florida offices. You place accounts through a secure portal that takes a simple A/R export. No recovery, no fee.

Two decades of receivables recovery — nationwide

A documented, compliant recovery process a busy multi-office firm can plug in alongside its own billing team — without adding collections staff or putting client goodwill at risk.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

Commercial & B2B collections since 2004

Nationwide — all 50 states

12 offices across 7 states

Skip tracing on businesses & principals

Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY

FINANCIAL SERVICES
Review

FSR • TOP 10 LIST
2025 Recognition

INTERNATIONAL
Business Times

CFO Tech
Outlook

insideARM

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



 ★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

The questions a law firm asks — answered directly

Exactly how we work, in plain terms, before a single account is placed.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. Fee structure	Pure contingency — \$0 upfront, no retainer, no monthly minimum. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we actually recover. The rate scales with the age and size of the balances; we quote your rate once we see a representative sample of your fee A/R.
2. Will this hurt our reputation with clients?	This matters for a firm built on reviews and referrals, and it's how we're built. Recovery is professional and fully compliant — no threats, no misrepresentation. We represent Musca Law with the same firmness your own brand carries, protecting the relationship while pursuing the balance.
3. Compliance & sensitive matters	FDCPA, Reg F and TCPA guardrails on every account, with discreet, defensible handling of the fact that a balance relates to legal representation. Licensed and bonded where required. Every contact is documented.
4. What to place — and when	Earned-but-unpaid flat-fee and retainer balances, defaulted in-house payment plans, and post-representation shortfalls. (Balances financed through a third-party lender such as LendingUSA are the lender's paper, not yours — we focus on what the firm still carries.) Place at roughly 90 days past due — the earlier a balance is placed, the more of it we recover.
5. Onboarding & placement	Low-lift. Export an A/R / outstanding-balance report from your practice-management or billing system (Clio, LawPay, PracticePanther, or a simple spreadsheet) and upload it through our secure portal — we map your columns, no re-keying. Outreach begins within 24–48 hours of a documented placement.

Billing-system-ready intake and full visibility, on demand

Every placement is managed through our secure portal — built to take your fee-A/R export and give your billing staff live, self-service visibility throughout recovery.

BILLING-SYSTEM-READY PLACEMENT

Upload an outstanding-balance export from Clio, PracticePanther, LawPay or your billing system — we map your columns, no re-keying.

SECURE FILE EXCHANGE

Send fee agreements, invoices and payment-plan records safely inside the portal — the documentation that resolves disputes fast, handled discreetly.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Run and export account and recovery reports on demand — a live view of what's been recovered across all your offices.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments a client makes directly to the firm, so balances stay accurate and no one is over-contacted.

► [Portal Video Tour](#)

SWRS Legal & Professional-Services Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's **law-firm** and **professional-services book** — litigation, family, general-practice and specialty firms — anonymized by practice type, individual client names withheld. Real recovered dollars on placed fee A/R.

BOUTIQUE LITIGATION FIRM

Civil litigation practice

\$3K recovered

of ~\$3K placed

100% recovered

FAMILY & CIVIL-LITIGATION FIRM

Multi-attorney practice

\$212K recovered

of ~\$273K placed

78% recovered

MULTI-PRACTICE LAW FIRM

Specialty legal practice

\$5K recovered

of ~\$8K placed

61% recovered

GENERAL-PRACTICE LAW FIRM

Community law office

\$4K recovered

of ~\$9K placed

46% recovered

SOLO FAMILY-LAW PRACTICE

Matrimonial & family law

\$1K recovered

of ~\$5K placed

24% recovered

TRIAL & LITIGATION FIRM

Plaintiff / trial practice

\$3K recovered

of ~\$15K placed

21% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

THE COST OF WAITING

Why legal-fee balances recover best while they're fresh

A fee balance is most collectible while the matter is fresh — the representation is recent, contact details are current, and the client still associates the balance with the work you did. Every month it ages, people move, memories fade, and the balance competes with newer bills. The highest-leverage change a firm can make isn't chasing harder — it's placing sooner.

THE AGE CURVE

Fresh balances (under ~90–120 days past due) resolve at materially higher rates; balances left a year or more collect a fraction of that.

THE STANDING RULE

A simple “place at 90 days” policy recovers more than letting balances drift toward write-off — and on contingency there's no cost to placing.

Real placed-versus-recovered results from SWRS's law-firm and professional-services book, anonymized by practice type; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance size and documentation; we give an honest, age-based read on a representative sample first.

We understand a legal ledger

A flat-fee, retainer and payment-plan practice creates a specific receivables profile. Our playbook is built for exactly that.



Earned-but-unpaid fee balances

Flat-fee and retainer shortfalls the firm has earned but the client stopped paying once the case resolved — pursued professionally without straining your staff.



Defaulted in-house payment plans

The customized payment arrangements you offer in appropriate cases — worked exactly when they break, on contingency.



Post-representation shortfalls

Balances your billing team has chased as far as it can after a matter closes — taken off their plate and pursued with persistent, compliant demand.



Reputation-first & discreet

Professional, compliant contact that protects a statewide firm's name and the reviews you've earned — with discretion appropriate to legal matters.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that trims DSO and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. Along the way he became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement: businesses get paid faster when recovery is built on listening and respect rather than aggressive calls and empty threats.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person and every client relationship as worth protecting. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally — an operator who has actually done the job, not a manager who has only overseen it.

“Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.”

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for Musca Law

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The Cost of Waiting: DSO & Commercial Recovery

B2B receivables · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Placement-File Standard

Maximizing recovery · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

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Let's turn your unpaid fee balances back into cash.

A quick call to walk your fee A/R, answer your questions, and put a contingency rate against a representative sample of your accounts.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

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12 offices across 7 states · nationwide recovery. Licensed & bonded where required. FDCPA / Reg F compliant · ACA International member. Private & confidential — prepared for Musca Law.